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METHOD AND DEVICE FOR SIGNALING VIDEO INFORMATION APPLICABLE AT PICTURE LEVEL OR SLICE LEVEL

Abstract

A video decoding method performed by a decoding device according to the present disclosure comprises the steps of: acquiring indication information indicating whether one or more tools for the current block can be applied at a picture level or slice level; determining, on the basis of the indication information, whether information related to the one or more tools is present in a picture header or a slice header; parsing the information related to the one or more tools from the picture header or the slice header on the basis of the determination result; and decoding the current block on the basis of the information related to the one or more tools.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a Continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/784,322 filed on Jun. 10, 2022, now allowed, which is a National Stage filing under 35 U.S.C. 371 of International Application No. PCT/KR2020/018067, with an international filing date of Dec. 10, 2020, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/947,532 filed on Dec. 12, 2019 all of which are incorporated by reference in their entirety herein.

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

Field of the Disclosure

[0002] The present disclosure relates to an image coding technology and, most particularly, to a method and device for signaling image (or video) information applicable at a picture level or a slice level in an image coding system.

Related Art

[0003] Recently, the demand for high-resolution and high-quality images, such as High Definition (HD) images and Ultra High Definition (UHD) images has been increasing in various fields. As the resolution and quality of the image data become higher, the information size or bit size that is being transmitted increases as compared to the existing image data. Therefore, when transmitting image data by using a same medium, such as a conventional (or existing) wired/wireless broadband line, or when using a conventional (or existing) storage medium to store image data, transmission cost and storage cost may be increased.

[0004] Accordingly, a high efficiency image compression technique for effectively transmitting or storing and reproducing (or playing-back) information on high-resolution and high-quality image is required.

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

Technical Objects

[0005] A technical object of the present disclosure is to provide a method and apparatus for increased image coding efficiency.

[0006] Another technical object of the present disclosure is to provide a method and device for signaling image (or video) information applicable at a picture level or a slice level.

[0007] Yet another technical object of the present disclosure is to provide a method and device for performing decoding on a current block based on image (or video) information that is applicable at a picture level or a slice level.

Technical Solutions

[0008] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, provided herein is an image decoding method performed by a decoding apparatus. The method may include the steps of obtaining indication information indicating whether at least one tool for a current block is applied at a picture level or a slice level, determining whether information related to the at least one tool is present in a picture header or in a slice header based on the indication information, parsing the information related to the at least one tool from the picture header or the slice header based on the determination, and decoding the current block based on the information related to the at least one tool.

[0009] According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, provided herein is an image encoding method performed by an encoding apparatus. The method may include the steps of

generating indication information indicating whether at least one tool that is to be applied to a current block is applied at a picture level or a slice level, generating information related to the at least one tool, and encoding the indication information and image information including the information related to the at least one tool. And, herein, the indication information indicates whether the information related to the at least one tool is present in a picture header or in a slice header.

[0010] According to yet another embodiment of the present disclosure, provided herein is a computer readable digital recording medium having encoded image information stored therein that allows an image decoding method to be performed by a decoding apparatus. The image decoding method according to the embodiment may include the steps of obtaining indication information indicating whether at least one tool that is to be applied to a current block is applied at a picture level or a slice level, determining whether information related to the at least one tool is present in a picture header or in a slice header based on the indication information, parsing the information related to the at least one tool from the picture header or the slice header based on the determination, and decoding the current block based on the information related to the at least one tool.

Effects of the Disclosure

[0011] According to the present specification, overall image/video compression efficiency may be increased.

[0012] According to the present specification, efficiency in image decoding may be increased based on indication information indicating whether at least one tool for a current block is applied at a picture level or a slice level.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0013] FIG. 1 schematically illustrates an example of a video/image coding system to which the present disclosure is applicable.

[0014] FIG. 2 is a diagram schematically illustrating a configuration of a video/image encoding apparatus to which the present disclosure is applicable.

[0015] FIG. 3 is a diagram schematically illustrating a configuration of a video/image decoding apparatus to which the present disclosure is applicable.

[0016] FIG. 4 illustrates an exemplary hierarchical structure of coded data.

[0017] FIG. 5 is a flowchart illustrating a method for performing deblocking filtering according to an embodiment.

[0018] FIG. 6 is a flowchart schematically illustrating an example of an ALF procedure.

[0019] FIG. 7 illustrates an example of a filter shape for ALF.

[0020] FIG. 8 is a flowchart illustrating an operation of an image encoding apparatus according to an embodiment.

[0021] FIG. 9 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an image encoding apparatus according to an embodiment.

[0022] FIG. 10 is a flowchart illustrating an operation of an image decoding apparatus according to an embodiment.

[0023] FIG. 11 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an image decoding apparatus according to an embodiment.

[0024] FIG. 12 shows an example of a content streaming system to which embodiments disclosed in the present specification may be applied.

DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

[0025] The present document may be modified in various forms, and specific embodiments thereof

will be described and shown in the drawings. However, the embodiments are not intended for limiting the present document. The terms used in the following description are used to merely describe specific embodiments, but are not intended to limit the present document. An expression of a singular number includes an expression of the plural number, so long as it is clearly read differently. The terms such as “include” and “have” are intended to indicate that features, numbers, steps, operations, elements, components, or combinations thereof used in the following description exist and it should be thus understood that the possibility of existence or addition of one or more different features, numbers, steps, operations, elements, components, or combinations thereof is not excluded.

[0026] Meanwhile, each configuration in the drawings described in the present document is shown independently for the convenience of description regarding different characteristic functions, and does not mean that each configuration is implemented as separate hardware or separate software. For example, two or more components among each component may be combined to form one component, or one component may be divided into a plurality of components. An embodiment in which elements are combined and/or separated is also included in the scope of rights of this document unless it deviates from the essence of this document.

[0027] In the present disclosure, the term “A or B” may mean “only A”, “only B”, or “both A and B”. In other words, in the present disclosure, the term “A or B” may be interpreted to indicate “A and/or B”. For example, in the present disclosure, the term “A, B or C” may mean “only A”, “only B”, “only C”, or “any combination of A, B and C”.

[0028] A slash “/” or a comma used in the present disclosure may mean “and/or”. For example, “A/B” may mean “A and/or B”. Accordingly, “A/B” may mean “only A”, “only B”, or “both A and B”. For example, “A, B, C” may mean “A, B or C”.

[0029] In the present disclosure, “at least one of A and B” may mean “only A”, “only B”, or “both A and B”. Further, in the present disclosure, the expression “at least one of A or B” or “at least one of A and/or B” may be interpreted the same as “at least one of A and B”.

[0030] Further, in the present disclosure, “at least one of A, B and C” may mean “only A”, “only B”, “only C”, or “any combination of A, B and C”. Further, “at least one of A, B or C” or “at least one of A, B and/or C” may mean “at least one of A, B and C”.

[0031] Further, the parentheses used in the present disclosure may mean “for example”.

Specifically, in the case that “prediction (intra prediction)” is expressed, it may be indicated that “intra prediction” is proposed as an example of “prediction”. In other words, the term “prediction” in the present disclosure is not limited to “intra prediction”, and it may be indicated that “intra prediction” is proposed as an example of “prediction”. Further, even in the case that “prediction (i.e., intra prediction)” is expressed, it may be indicated that “intra prediction” is proposed as an example of “prediction”.

[0032] Technical features that are individually described in a diagram of the present specification may be implemented individually, or may be implemented simultaneously.

[0033] Hereinafter, a preferred embodiment of the present disclosure will be described in more detail with reference to the appended drawings. Hereinafter, same reference numerals will be used for indicating the same configuration elements within the drawings, and overlapping (or repetitive) description of the same configuration element(s) will be omitted for simplicity.

[0034] FIG. 1 schematically illustrates an example of a video/image coding system to which the present disclosure is applicable.

[0035] Referring to FIG. 1, a video/image coding system may include a first device (a source device) and a second device (a reception device). The source device may transmit encoded video/image information or data to the reception device through a digital storage medium or network in the form of a file or streaming.

[0036] The source device may include a video source, an encoding apparatus, and a transmitter. The receiving device may include a receiver, a decoding apparatus, and a renderer. The encoding

apparatus may be called a video/image encoding apparatus, and the decoding apparatus may be called a video/image decoding apparatus. The transmitter may be included in the encoding apparatus. The receiver may be included in the decoding apparatus. The renderer may include a display, and the display may be configured as a separate device or an external component.

[0037] The video source may acquire video/image through a process of capturing, synthesizing, or generating the video/image. The video source may include a video/image capture device and/or a video/image generating device. The video/image capture device may include, for example, one or more cameras, video/image archives including previously captured video/images, and the like. The video/image generating device may include, for example, computers, tablets and smartphones, and may (electronically) generate video/images. For example, a virtual video/image may be generated through a computer or the like. In this case, the video/image capturing process may be replaced by a process of generating related data.

[0038] The encoding apparatus may encode input video/image. The encoding apparatus may perform a series of procedures such as prediction, transform, and quantization for compaction and coding efficiency. The encoded data (encoded video/image information) may be output in the form of a bitstream.

[0039] The transmitter may transmit the encoded image/image information or data output in the form of a bitstream to the receiver of the receiving device through a digital storage medium or a network in the form of a file or streaming. The digital storage medium may include various storage mediums such as USB, SD, CD, DVD, Blu-ray, HDD, SSD, and the like. The transmitter may include an element for generating a media file through a predetermined file format and may include an element for transmission through a broadcast/communication network. The receiver may receive/extract the bitstream and transmit the received bitstream to the decoding apparatus.

[0040] The decoding apparatus may decode the video/image by performing a series of procedures such as dequantization, inverse transform, and prediction corresponding to the operation of the encoding apparatus.

[0041] The renderer may render the decoded video/image. The rendered video/image may be displayed through the display.

[0042] The present specification relates to video/image coding. For example, the method/example disclosed in the present specification may be applied to a method that is disclosed in a Versatile Video Coding (VVC) standard, an essential video coding (EVC) standard, an AOMedia Video 1 (AV1) standard, a 2nd generation of audio video coding standard (AVS2), or other next-generation video/image coding standard(s) (e.g., H.267 or H.268, and so on).

[0043] The present document suggests various embodiments of video/image coding, and the above embodiments may also be performed in combination with each other unless otherwise specified.

[0044] In the present document, a video may refer to a series of images over time. A picture generally refers to the unit representing one image at a particular time frame, and a slice/tile refers to the unit constituting a part of the picture in terms of coding. A slice/tile may include one or more coding tree units (CTUs). One picture may consist of one or more slices/tiles.

[0045] A tile is a rectangular region of CTUs within a particular tile column and a particular tile row in a picture. The tile column is a rectangular region of CTUs having a height equal to the height of the picture and a width specified by syntax elements in the picture parameter set. The tile row is a rectangular region of CTUs having a width specified by syntax elements in the picture parameter set and a height equal to the height of the picture. A tile scan is a specific sequential ordering of CTUs partitioning a picture in which the CTUs are ordered consecutively in CTU raster scan in a tile whereas tiles in a picture are ordered consecutively in a raster scan of the tiles of the picture. A slice may include a plurality of whole (or complete) tiles or a plurality of consecutive (or contiguous) CTU matrices within one tile of a picture that may be included in one NAL unit. In the present specification, a tile group and a slice may be interchangeably used. For example, in the present specification, a tile group/tile group header may be referred to as a slice/slice header.

[0046] Meanwhile, one picture may be divided into two or more subpictures. A subpicture may be a rectangular region of one or more slices within a picture.

[0047] A pixel or a pel may mean a smallest unit constituting one picture (or image). Also, 'sample' may be used as a term corresponding to a pixel. A sample may generally represent a pixel or a value of a pixel, and may represent only a pixel/pixel value of a luma component or only a pixel/pixel value of a chroma component.

[0048] A unit may represent a basic unit of image processing. The unit may include at least one of a specific region of the picture and information related to the region. One unit may include one luma block and two chroma (e.g., cb, cr) blocks. The unit may be used interchangeably with terms such as block or area in some cases. In a general case, an $M \times N$ block may include samples (or sample arrays) or a set (or array) of transform coefficients of M columns and N rows.

[0049] FIG. 2 is a diagram schematically illustrating a configuration of a video/image encoding apparatus to which the present disclosure is applicable. Hereinafter, a video encoding apparatus may include an image encoding apparatus.

[0050] Referring to FIG. 2, the encoding apparatus **200** includes an image partitioner **210**, a predictor **220**, a residual processor **230**, and an entropy encoder **240**, an adder **250**, a filter **260**, and a memory **270**. The predictor **220** may include an inter predictor **221** and an intra predictor **222**. The residual processor **230** may include a transformer **232**, a quantizer **233**, a dequantizer **234**, and an inverse transformer **235**. The residual processor **230** may further include a subtractor **231**. The adder **250** may be called a reconstructor or a reconstructed block generator. The image partitioner **210**, the predictor **220**, the residual processor **230**, the entropy encoder **240**, the adder **250**, and the filter **260** may be configured by at least one hardware component (e.g., an encoder chipset or processor) according to an embodiment. In addition, the memory **270** may include a decoded picture buffer (DPB) or may be configured by a digital storage medium. The hardware component may further include the memory **270** as an internal/external component.

[0051] The image partitioner **210** may partition an input image (or a picture or a frame) input to the encoding apparatus **200** into one or more processors. For example, the processor may be called a coding unit (CU). In this case, the coding unit may be recursively partitioned according to a quad-tree binary-tree ternary-tree (QTBT-TT) structure from a coding tree unit (CTU) or a largest coding unit (LCU). For example, one coding unit may be partitioned into a plurality of coding units of a deeper depth based on a quad tree structure, a binary tree structure, and/or a ternary structure. In this case, for example, the quad tree structure may be applied first and the binary tree structure and/or ternary structure may be applied later. Alternatively, the binary tree structure may be applied first. The coding procedure according to the present disclosure may be performed based on the final coding unit that is no longer partitioned. In this case, the largest coding unit may be used as the final coding unit based on coding efficiency according to image characteristics, or if necessary, the coding unit may be recursively partitioned into coding units of deeper depth and a coding unit having an optimal size may be used as the final coding unit. Here, the coding procedure may include a procedure of prediction, transform, and reconstruction, which will be described later. As another example, the processor may further include a prediction unit (PU) or a transform unit (TU). In this case, the prediction unit and the transform unit may be split or partitioned from the aforementioned final coding unit. The prediction unit may be a unit of sample prediction, and the transform unit may be a unit for deriving a transform coefficient and/or a unit for deriving a residual signal from the transform coefficient.

[0052] The unit may be used interchangeably with terms such as block or area in some cases. In a general case, an $M \times N$ block may represent a set of samples or transform coefficients composed of M columns and N rows. A sample may generally represent a pixel or a value of a pixel, may represent only a pixel/pixel value of a luma component or represent only a pixel/pixel value of a chroma component. A sample may be used as a term corresponding to one picture (or image) for a pixel or a pel.

[0053] In the encoding apparatus **200**, a prediction signal (predicted block, prediction sample array) output from the inter predictor **221** or the intra predictor **222** is subtracted from an input image signal (original block, original sample array) to generate a residual signal residual block, residual sample array), and the generated residual signal is transmitted to the transformer **232**. In this case, as shown, a part for subtracting a prediction signal (predicted block, prediction sample array) from the input image signal (original block, original sample array) in the encoder **200** may be called a subtractor **231**. The predictor may perform prediction on a block to be processed (hereinafter, referred to as a current block) and generate a predicted block including prediction samples for the current block. The predictor may determine whether intra prediction or inter prediction is applied on a current block or CU basis. As described later in the description of each prediction mode, the predictor may generate various information related to prediction, such as prediction mode information, and transmit the generated information to the entropy encoder **240**. The information on the prediction may be encoded in the entropy encoder **240** and output in the form of a bitstream.

[0054] The intra predictor **222** may predict the current block by referring to the samples in the current picture. The referred samples may be located in the neighborhood of the current block or may be located apart according to the prediction mode. In the intra prediction, prediction modes may include a plurality of non-directional modes and a plurality of directional modes. The non-directional mode may include, for example, a DC mode and a planar mode. The directional mode may include, for example, 33 directional prediction modes or 65 directional prediction modes according to the degree of detail of the prediction direction. However, this is merely an example, more or less directional prediction modes may be used depending on a setting. The intra predictor **222** may determine the prediction mode applied to the current block by using a prediction mode applied to a neighboring block.

[0055] The inter predictor **221** may derive a predicted block for the current block based on a reference block (reference sample array) specified by a motion vector on a reference picture. Here, in order to reduce the amount of motion information transmitted in the inter prediction mode, the motion information may be predicted in units of blocks, sub-blocks, or samples based on correlation of motion information between the neighboring block and the current block. The motion information may include a motion vector and a reference picture index. The motion information may further include inter prediction direction (L0 prediction, L1 prediction, Bi prediction, and so on) information. In the case of inter prediction, the neighboring block may include a spatial neighboring block present in the current picture and a temporal neighboring block present in the reference picture. The reference picture including the reference block and the reference picture including the temporal neighboring block may be the same or different. The temporal neighboring block may be called a collocated reference block, a co-located CU (colCU), and the like, and the reference picture including the temporal neighboring block may be called a collocated picture (colPic). For example, the inter predictor **221** may configure a motion information candidate list based on neighboring blocks and generate information indicating which candidate is used to derive a motion vector and/or a reference picture index of the current block. Inter prediction may be performed based on various prediction modes. For example, in the case of a skip mode and a merge mode, the inter predictor **221** may use motion information of the neighboring block as motion information of the current block. In the skip mode, unlike the merge mode, the residual signal may not be transmitted. In the case of the motion vector prediction (MVP) mode, the motion vector of the neighboring block may be used as a motion vector predictor and the motion vector of the current block may be indicated by signaling a motion vector difference.

[0056] The predictor **220** may generate a prediction signal based on various prediction methods described below. For example, the predictor may not only apply intra prediction or inter prediction to predict one block but also simultaneously apply both intra prediction and inter prediction. This may be called combined inter and intra prediction (CIIP). In addition, the predictor may be based on an intra block copy (IBC) prediction mode or a palette mode for prediction of a block. The IBC

prediction mode or palette mode may be used for content image/video coding of a game or the like, for example, screen content coding (SCC). The IBC basically performs prediction in the current picture but may be performed similarly to inter prediction in that a reference block is derived in the current picture. That is, the IBC may use at least one of the inter prediction techniques described in the present disclosure. The palette mode may be considered as an example of intra coding or intra prediction. When the palette mode is applied, a sample value within a picture may be signaled based on information on the palette table and the palette index.

[0057] The prediction signal generated by the predictor (including the inter predictor **221** and/or the intra predictor **222**) may be used to generate a reconstructed signal or to generate a residual signal. The transformer **232** may generate transform coefficients by applying a transform technique to the residual signal. For example, the transform technique may include at least one of a discrete cosine transform (DCT), a discrete sine transform (DST), a karhunen-loève transform (KLT), a graph-based transform (GBT), or a conditionally non-linear transform (CNT). Here, the GBT means transform obtained from a graph when relationship information between pixels is represented by the graph. The CNT refers to transform generated based on a prediction signal generated using all previously reconstructed pixels. In addition, the transform process may be applied to square pixel blocks having the same size or may be applied to blocks having a variable size rather than square.

[0058] The quantizer **233** may quantize the transform coefficients and transmit them to the entropy encoder **240** and the entropy encoder **240** may encode the quantized signal (information on the quantized transform coefficients) and output a bitstream. The information on the quantized transform coefficients may be referred to as residual information. The quantizer **233** may rearrange block type quantized transform coefficients into a one-dimensional vector form based on a coefficient scanning order and generate information on the quantized transform coefficients based on the quantized transform coefficients in the one-dimensional vector form. Information on transform coefficients may be generated. The entropy encoder **240** may perform various encoding methods such as, for example, exponential Golomb, context-adaptive variable length coding (CAVLC), context-adaptive binary arithmetic coding (CABAC), and the like. The entropy encoder **240** may encode information necessary for video/image reconstruction other than quantized transform coefficients (e.g., values of syntax elements, and so on) together or separately. Encoded information (e.g., encoded video/image information) may be transmitted or stored in units of NALs (network abstraction layer) in the form of a bitstream. The video/image information may further include information on various parameter sets such as an adaptation parameter set (APS), a picture parameter set (PPS), a sequence parameter set (SPS), or a video parameter set (VPS). In addition, the video/image information may further include general constraint information. In the present disclosure, information and/or syntax elements transmitted/signaled from the encoding apparatus to the decoding apparatus may be included in video/picture information. The video/image information may be encoded through the above-described encoding procedure and included in the bitstream. The bitstream may be transmitted over a network or may be stored in a digital storage medium. The network may include a broadcasting network and/or a communication network, and the digital storage medium may include various storage media such as USB, SD, CD, DVD, Blu-ray, HDD, SSD, and the like. A transmitter (not shown) transmitting a signal output from the entropy encoder **240** and/or a storage part (not shown) storing the signal may be included as internal/external element of the encoding apparatus **200**, and alternatively, the transmitter may be included in the entropy encoder **240**.

[0059] The quantized transform coefficients output from the quantizer **233** may be used to generate a prediction signal. For example, the residual signal (residual block or residual samples) may be reconstructed by applying dequantization and inverse transform to the quantized transform coefficients through the dequantizer **234** and the inverse transformer **235**. The adder **250** adds the reconstructed residual signal to the prediction signal output from the inter predictor **221** or the intra predictor **222** to generate a reconstructed signal (reconstructed picture, reconstructed block,

reconstructed sample array). If there is no residual for the block to be processed, such as a case where the skip mode is applied, the predicted block may be used as the reconstructed block. The adder **250** may be called a reconstructor or a reconstructed block generator. The generated reconstructed signal may be used for intra prediction of a next block to be processed in the current picture and may be used for inter prediction of a next picture through filtering as described below. [0060] Meanwhile, luma mapping with chroma scaling (LMCS) may be applied during picture encoding and/or reconstruction.

[0061] The filter **260** may improve subjective/objective image quality by applying filtering to the reconstructed signal. For example, the filter **260** may generate a modified reconstructed picture by applying various filtering methods to the reconstructed picture and store the modified reconstructed picture in the memory **270**, specifically, a DPB of the memory **270**. The various filtering methods may include, for example, deblocking filtering, a sample adaptive offset, an adaptive loop filter, a bilateral filter, and the like. The filter **260** may generate various information related to the filtering and transmit the generated information to the entropy encoder **240** as described later in the description of each filtering method. The information related to the filtering may be encoded by the entropy encoder **240** and output in the form of a bitstream.

[0062] The modified reconstructed picture transmitted to the memory **270** may be used as the reference picture in the inter predictor **221**. When the inter prediction is applied through the encoding apparatus, prediction mismatch between the encoding apparatus **200** and the decoding apparatus **300** may be avoided and encoding efficiency may be improved.

[0063] The DPB of the memory **270** DPB may store the modified reconstructed picture for use as a reference picture in the inter predictor **221**. The memory **270** may store the motion information of the block from which the motion information in the current picture is derived (or encoded) and/or the motion information of the blocks in the picture that have already been reconstructed. The stored motion information may be transmitted to the inter predictor **221** and used as the motion information of the spatial neighboring block or the motion information of the temporal neighboring block. The memory **270** may store reconstructed samples of reconstructed blocks in the current picture and may transfer the reconstructed samples to the intra predictor **222**.

[0064] FIG. **3** is a diagram schematically illustrating a configuration of a video/image decoding apparatus to which the present disclosure is applicable.

[0065] Referring to FIG. **3**, the decoding apparatus **300** may include an entropy decoder **310**, a residual processor **320**, a predictor **330**, an adder **340**, a filter **350**, a memory **360**. The predictor **330** may include an inter predictor **331** and an intra predictor **332**. The residual processor **320** may include a dequantizer **321** and an inverse transformer **321**. The entropy decoder **310**, the residual processor **320**, the predictor **330**, the adder **340**, and the filter **350** may be configured by a hardware component (e.g., a decoder chipset or a processor) according to an embodiment. In addition, the memory **360** may include a decoded picture buffer (DPB) or may be configured by a digital storage medium. The hardware component may further include the memory **360** as an internal/external component.

[0066] When a bitstream including video/image information is input, the decoding apparatus **300** may reconstruct an image corresponding to a process in which the video/image information is processed in the encoding apparatus of FIG. **2**. For example, the decoding apparatus **300** may derive units/blocks based on block partition related information obtained from the bitstream. The decoding apparatus **300** may perform decoding using a processor applied in the encoding apparatus. Thus, the processor of decoding may be a coding unit, for example, and the coding unit may be partitioned according to a quad tree structure, binary tree structure and/or ternary tree structure from the coding tree unit or the largest coding unit. One or more transform units may be derived from the coding unit. The reconstructed image signal decoded and output through the decoding apparatus **300** may be reproduced through a reproducing apparatus.

[0067] The decoding apparatus **300** may receive a signal output from the encoding apparatus of

FIG. 2 in the form of a bitstream, and the received signal may be decoded through the entropy decoder **310**. For example, the entropy decoder **310** may parse the bitstream to derive information (e.g., video/image information) necessary for image reconstruction (or picture reconstruction). The video/image information may further include information on various parameter sets such as an adaptation parameter set (APS), a picture parameter set (PPS), a sequence parameter set (SPS), or a video parameter set (VPS). In addition, the video/image information may further include general constraint information. The decoding apparatus may further decode picture based on the information on the parameter set and/or the general constraint information. Signaled/received information and/or syntax elements described later in the present disclosure may be decoded may decode the decoding procedure and obtained from the bitstream. For example, the entropy decoder **310** decodes the information in the bitstream based on a coding method such as exponential Golomb coding, CAVLC, or CABAC, and output syntax elements required for image reconstruction and quantized values of transform coefficients for residual. More specifically, the CABAC entropy decoding method may receive a bin corresponding to each syntax element in the bitstream, determine a context model using a decoding target syntax element information, decoding information of a decoding target block or information of a symbol/bin decoded in a previous stage, and perform an arithmetic decoding on the bin by predicting a probability of occurrence of a bin according to the determined context model, and generate a symbol corresponding to the value of each syntax element. In this case, the CABAC entropy decoding method may update the context model by using the information of the decoded symbol/bin for a context model of a next symbol/bin after determining the context model. The information related to the prediction among the information decoded by the entropy decoder **310** may be provided to the predictor (the inter predictor **332** and the intra predictor **331**), and the residual value on which the entropy decoding was performed in the entropy decoder **310**, that is, the quantized transform coefficients and related parameter information, may be input to the residual processor **320**. The residual processor **320** may derive the residual signal (the residual block, the residual samples, the residual sample array). In addition, information on filtering among information decoded by the entropy decoder **310** may be provided to the filter **350**. Meanwhile, a receiver (not shown) for receiving a signal output from the encoding apparatus may be further configured as an internal/external element of the decoding apparatus **300**, or the receiver may be a component of the entropy decoder **310**. Meanwhile, the decoding apparatus according to the present disclosure may be referred to as a video/image/picture decoding apparatus, and the decoding apparatus may be classified into an information decoder (video/image/picture information decoder) and a sample decoder (video/image/picture sample decoder). The information decoder may include the entropy decoder **310**, and the sample decoder may include at least one of the dequantizer **321**, the inverse transformer **322**, the adder **340**, the filter **350**, the memory **360**, the inter predictor **332**, and the intra predictor **331**.

[0068] The dequantizer **321** may dequantize the quantized transform coefficients and output the transform coefficients. The dequantizer **321** may rearrange the quantized transform coefficients in the form of a two-dimensional block form. In this case, the rearrangement may be performed based on the coefficient scanning order performed in the encoding apparatus. The dequantizer **321** may perform dequantization on the quantized transform coefficients by using a quantization parameter (e.g., quantization step size information) and obtain transform coefficients.

[0069] The inverse transformer **322** inversely transforms the transform coefficients to obtain a residual signal (residual block, residual sample array).

[0070] The predictor may perform prediction on the current block and generate a predicted block including prediction samples for the current block. The predictor may determine whether intra prediction or inter prediction is applied to the current block based on the information on the prediction output from the entropy decoder **310** and may determine a specific intra/inter prediction mode.

[0071] The predictor **320** may generate a prediction signal based on various prediction methods

described below. For example, the predictor may not only apply intra prediction or inter prediction to predict one block but also simultaneously apply intra prediction and inter prediction. This may be called combined inter and intra prediction (CIIP). In addition, the predictor may be based on an intra block copy (IBC) prediction mode or a palette mode for prediction of a block. The IBC prediction mode or palette mode may be used for content image/video coding of a game or the like, for example, screen content coding (SCC). The IBC basically performs prediction in the current picture but may be performed similarly to inter prediction in that a reference block is derived in the current picture. That is, the IBC may use at least one of the inter prediction techniques described in the present disclosure. The palette mode may be considered as an example of intra coding or intra prediction. When the palette mode is applied, a sample value within a picture may be signaled based on information on the palette table and the palette index.

[0072] The intra predictor **331** may predict the current block by referring to the samples in the current picture. The referred samples may be located in the neighborhood of the current block or may be located apart according to the prediction mode. In the intra prediction, prediction modes may include a plurality of non-directional modes and a plurality of directional modes. The intra predictor **331** may determine the prediction mode applied to the current block by using a prediction mode applied to a neighboring block.

[0073] The inter predictor **332** may derive a predicted block for the current block based on a reference block (reference sample array) specified by a motion vector on a reference picture. In this case, in order to reduce the amount of motion information transmitted in the inter prediction mode, motion information may be predicted in units of blocks, sub-blocks, or samples based on correlation of motion information between the neighboring block and the current block. The motion information may include a motion vector and a reference picture index. The motion information may further include inter prediction direction (L0 prediction, L1 prediction, Bi prediction, and so on) information. In the case of inter prediction, the neighboring block may include a spatial neighboring block present in the current picture and a temporal neighboring block present in the reference picture. For example, the inter predictor **332** may configure a motion information candidate list based on neighboring blocks and derive a motion vector of the current block and/or a reference picture index based on the received candidate selection information. Inter prediction may be performed based on various prediction modes, and the information on the prediction may include information indicating a mode of inter prediction for the current block.

[0074] The adder **340** may generate a reconstructed signal (reconstructed picture, reconstructed block, reconstructed sample array) by adding the obtained residual signal to the prediction signal (predicted block, predicted sample array) output from the predictor (including the inter predictor **332** and/or the intra predictor **331**). If there is no residual for the block to be processed, such as when the skip mode is applied, the predicted block may be used as the reconstructed block.

[0075] The adder **340** may be called reconstructor or a reconstructed block generator. The generated reconstructed signal may be used for intra prediction of a next block to be processed in the current picture, may be output through filtering as described below, or may be used for inter prediction of a next picture.

[0076] Meanwhile, luma mapping with chroma scaling (LMCS) may be applied in the picture decoding process.

[0077] The filter **350** may improve subjective/objective image quality by applying filtering to the reconstructed signal. For example, the filter **350** may generate a modified reconstructed picture by applying various filtering methods to the reconstructed picture and store the modified reconstructed picture in the memory **360**, specifically, a DPB of the memory **360**. The various filtering methods may include, for example, deblocking filtering, a sample adaptive offset, an adaptive loop filter, a bilateral filter, and the like.

[0078] The (modified) reconstructed picture stored in the DPB of the memory **360** may be used as a reference picture in the inter predictor **332**. The memory **360** may store the motion information of

the block from which the motion information in the current picture is derived (or decoded) and/or the motion information of the blocks in the picture that have already been reconstructed. The stored motion information may be transmitted to the inter predictor **260** so as to be utilized as the motion information of the spatial neighboring block or the motion information of the temporal neighboring block. The memory **360** may store reconstructed samples of reconstructed blocks in the current picture and transfer the reconstructed samples to the intra predictor **331**.

[0079] In the present document, the embodiments described in the filter **260**, the inter predictor **221**, and the intra predictor **222** of the encoding apparatus **200** may be the same as or respectively applied to correspond to the filter **350**, the inter predictor **332**, and the intra predictor **331** of the decoding apparatus **300**. The same may also apply to the inter predictor **332** and the intra predictor **331**.

[0080] As described above, in video coding, prediction is performed to increase compression efficiency. Through this, it is possible to generate a predicted block including prediction samples for a current block, which is a block to be coded. Here, the predicted block includes prediction samples in a spatial domain (or pixel domain). The predicted block is derived equally from the encoding device and the decoding device, and the encoding device decodes information (residual information) on the residual between the original block and the predicted block, not the original sample value of the original block itself. By signaling to the device, image coding efficiency can be increased. The decoding apparatus may derive a residual block including residual samples based on the residual information, and generate a reconstructed block including reconstructed samples by summing the residual block and the predicted block, and generate a reconstructed picture including reconstructed blocks.

[0081] The residual information may be generated through transformation and quantization processes. For example, the encoding apparatus may derive a residual block between the original block and the predicted block, and perform a transform process on residual samples (residual sample array) included in the residual block to derive transform coefficients, and then, by performing a quantization process on the transform coefficients, derive quantized transform coefficients to signal the residual related information to the decoding apparatus (via a bitstream). Here, the residual information may include location information, a transform technique, a transform kernel, and a quantization parameter, value information of the quantized transform coefficients, and so on. The decoding apparatus may perform dequantization/inverse transformation process based on the residual information and derive residual samples (or residual blocks). The decoding apparatus may generate a reconstructed picture based on the predicted block and the residual block. The encoding apparatus may also dequantize/inverse transform the quantized transform coefficients for reference for inter prediction of a later picture to derive a residual block, and generate a reconstructed picture based thereon. In the present document, at least one of quantization/dequantization and/or transform/inverse transform may be omitted. When the quantization/dequantization is omitted, the quantized transform coefficient may be referred to as a transform coefficient. When the transform/inverse transform is omitted, the transform coefficients may be called coefficients or residual coefficients, or may still be called transform coefficients for uniformity of expression. In the present document, a quantized transform coefficient and a transform coefficient may be referred to as a transform coefficient and a scaled transform coefficient, respectively. In this case, the residual information may include information on transform coefficient(s), and the information on the transform coefficient(s) may be signaled through residual coding syntax. Transform coefficients may be derived based on the residual information (or information on the transform coefficient(s)), and scaled transform coefficients may be derived through inverse transform (scaling) on the transform coefficients. Residual samples may be derived based on an inverse transform (transform) of the scaled transform coefficients. This may be applied/expressed in other parts of the present document as well.

[0082] FIG. 4 exemplarily shows a hierarchical structure for a coded data.

[0083] Referring to FIG. 4, the coded data may be divided into a video coding layer (VCL), which handles coding processing of a video/image and the video/image itself, and a Network abstraction layer (NAL), which exists between the VCL and a sub-system that stores and transmits the coded video/image.

[0084] The VCL may generate a parameter set (picture parameter set (PPS), sequence parameter set (SPS), video parameter set (VPS), and so on) corresponding to a header of a sequence and a picture, and so on, and a supplemental enhancement information (SEI) message that is additionally needed in the coding process of the video/image. The SEI message is separated from the information on the video/image (slice data). The VCL including the information on the video/image is configured of slice data and a slice header. Meanwhile, a slice header may be referred to as a tile group header, and slice data may be referred to as tile group data.

[0085] In the NAL, a NAL unit may be generated by adding header information (NAL unit header) to a raw byte sequence payload (RBSP) generated in a VCL. In this case, the RBSP refers to slice data, parameter set, SEI message, and so on, generated in the VCL. The NAL unit header may include NAL unit type information specified according to RBSP data included in the corresponding NAL unit.

[0086] A NAL unit performs a role of mapping a coded image to bit sequence of a sub-system, such as a file format, Real-time Transport Protocol (RTP), transport stream (TS), and so on.

[0087] As shown in the figure, the NAL unit may be classified into a VCL NAL unit and a Non-VCL NAL unit according to the RBSP generated in the VCL. The VCL NAL unit may mean a NAL unit that includes information on the image (slice data) on the image, and the Non-VCL NAL unit may mean a NAL unit that includes information (parameter set or SEI message) required for decoding the image.

[0088] The above-described VCL NAL unit and Non-VCL NAL unit may be transmitted through a network by attaching header information according to the data standard of the subsystem. For example, the NAL unit may be transformed into a data format of a predetermined standard such as an H.266/VVC file format, a real-time transport protocol (RTP), a transport stream (TS), and so on, and transmitted through various networks.

[0089] As described above, the NAL unit may be specified with the NAL unit type according to the RBSP data structure included in the corresponding NAL unit, and information on the NAL unit type may be stored and signaled in the NAL unit header.

[0090] For example, the NAL unit may be classified into a VCL NAL unit type and a Non-VCL NAL unit type according to whether the NAL unit includes information (slice data) about an image. The VCL NAL unit type may be classified according to the nature and type of pictures included in the VCL NAL unit, and the Non-VCL NAL unit type may be classified according to types of parameter sets.

[0091] The following is an example of a NAL unit type that is specified in accordance with a parameter set type that is included in a Non-VCL NAL unit type. For example, the NAL unit type may be specified as one of an Adaptation Parameter Set (APS) NAL unit, which is a NAL unit type including APS, a Decoding Parameter Set (DPS) NAL unit, which is a NAL unit type including DPS, a Video Parameter Set (VPS) NAL unit, which is a NAL unit type including VPS, a Sequence Parameter Set (SPS) NAL unit, which is a NAL unit type including SPS, and a Picture Parameter Set (PPS) NAL unit, which is a NAL unit type including PPS.

[0092] The aforementioned NAL unit types may have syntax information for the NAL unit type, and the syntax information may be stored and signaled in a NAL unit header. For example, the syntax information may be `nal_unit_type`, and NAL unit types may be specified by a `nal_unit_type` value.

[0093] Meanwhile, as described above, one picture may include a plurality of slices, and one slice may include a slice header and slice data. In this case, one picture header may be further added to a plurality of slices (a slice header and a slice data set) in one picture. The picture header (picture

header syntax) may include information/parameters commonly applicable to the picture. The slice header (slice header syntax) may include information/parameters that may be commonly applied to the slice. The APS (APS syntax) or the PPS (PPS syntax) may include information/parameters that may be commonly applied to one or more slices or pictures. The SPS (SPS syntax) may include information/parameters that may be commonly applied to one or more sequences. The VPS (VPS syntax) may include information/parameters that may be commonly applied to multiple layers. The DPS (DPS syntax) may include information/parameters that may be commonly applied to the overall video. The DPS may include information/parameters related to concatenation of a coded video sequence (CVS). The high level syntax (HLS) in the present document may include at least one of the APS syntax, the PPS syntax, the SPS syntax, the VPS syntax, the DPS syntax, and the slice header syntax.

[0094] In the present document, the image/image information encoded from the encoding apparatus and signaled to the decoding apparatus in the form of a bitstream includes not only partitioning related information in a picture, intra/inter prediction information, residual information, in-loop filtering information, and so on, but also information included in a slice header, information included in the APS, information included in the PPS, information included in an SPS, information included in the VPS and/or information included in the DPS. In addition, the image/image information may further include NAL unit header information.

[0095] Meanwhile, as described above, in order to enhance subjective/objective picture quality, the encoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may perform an in-loop filtering procedure for a reconstructed picture. A modified reconstructed picture may be generated through the in-loop filtering procedure, and the modified reconstructed picture may be outputted from the decoding apparatus as a decoded picture and may also be stored in the decoded picture buffer or memory of the encoding apparatus/the decoding apparatus. Additionally, in a later process, the modified reconstructed picture may be used as a reference picture in an inter prediction procedure when performing encoding/decoding. As described above, the in-loop filtering procedure may include a deblocking filtering procedure, a sample adaptive offset (SAO) procedure, and/or an adaptive loop filter (ALF) procedure. In this case, one or part of the deblocking filtering procedure, the sample adaptive offset (SAO) procedure, and the adaptive loop filter (ALF) procedure may be sequentially applied, or all of the procedures may be sequentially applied. For example, after applying the deblocking filtering procedure to a reconstructed picture, the SAO procedure may be performed. Alternatively, for example, after applying the deblocking filtering procedure to the reconstructed picture, the ALF procedure may be performed. This may be identically performed in the encoding apparatus.

[0096] The deblocking filtering procedure is a procedure that removes any distortion generated a reconstructed picture at a boundary between blocks. For example, the deblocking filtering procedure may derive a target boundary from the reconstructed picture, determine a boundary strength (bS) for the target boundary, and perform deblocking filtering for the target boundary based on the determined bS. The bS may be determined based on the prediction modes of two blocks being adjacent to the target block, a motion vector difference, whether or not the reference picture is the same, whether or not a non-zero significant coefficient exists, and so on.

[0097] The SAO procedure is a method for compensating an offset different between a reconstructed picture and an original picture in sample units. For example, the SAO procedure may be applied in accordance to an offset type, such as a band offset, an edge offset, and so on. According to the SAO, a sample may be sorted as different categories in accordance with the SAO type, and an offset value may be added to each sample in accordance with the category. Filtering information for the SAO may include information on the application or non-application of SAO, SAO type information, and SAO offset value information. For example, the SAO may be applied to a reconstructed picture after the application of deblocking filtering.

[0098] The adaptive loop filter (ALF) procedure is a procedure for filtering a reconstructed picture

in sample units, based on a filter coefficient according to a filter shape. The encoding apparatus may compare the reconstructed picture with the original picture so as to determine whether or not to apply the ALF, the ALF shape, and/or the ALF filtering coefficient, and so on, and may signal the reconstructed picture to the encoding apparatus. That is, the filtering information on the ALF procedure may include information on whether or not to apply the ALF, ALF shape information, ALF filtering coefficient information, and so on. The ALF procedure may be applied to a reconstructed picture after the application of deblocking filtering.

[0099] FIG. 5 is a flowchart illustrating a method for performing deblocking filtering according to an embodiment.

[0100] As described above, the encoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may reconstruct a picture in block units. When performing such image reconstruction in block units, a block distortion may occur at a boundary between blocks within the reconstructed picture. Therefore, in order to remove the block distortion that occurs at the boundary between blocks within the reconstructed picture, the encoding apparatus and the decoding apparatus may use a deblocking filter.

[0101] Therefore, the encoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may derive a boundary between blocks having deblocking filtering performed therein within the reconstructed picture. Meanwhile, a boundary having deblocking filtering performed therein may be referred to as an edge.

Additionally, the boundary having deblocking filtering performed therein may include two different types, and the two different types of boundaries may be a vertical boundary and a horizontal boundary. The vertical boundary may also be referred to as a vertical edge, and the horizontal boundary may also be referred to as a horizontal edge. The encoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may perform deblocking filtering on the vertical edge and may also perform deblocking filtering on the horizontal edge.

[0102] For example, the encoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may derive a target boundary that is to be processed with filtering from the reconstructed picture (S510).

[0103] Additionally, the decoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may determine a boundary strength (bS) for a boundary having deblocking filtering performed therein (S520). The bS may also be indicated as a boundary filtering strength. For example, a case where a bS value for a boundary (block edge) between block P and block Q is obtained may be assumed. In this case, the encoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may obtain a bS value for a boundary (block edge) between block P and block Q based on the block P and the block Q. For example, bS may be determined in accordance with the table shown below.

TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 The variable $bS[xD.sub.i][yD.sub.j]$ is derived as follows: If $cIdx$ is equal to 0 and both samples $p.sub.0$ and $q.sub.0$ are in a coding block with $intra_bpcm_flag$ equal to 1, $bS[xD.sub.i][yD.sub.j]$ is set equal to 0. Otherwise, if the sample $p.sub.0$ or $q.sub.0$ is in the coding block of a coding unit coded with intra prediction mode, $bS[xD.sub.i][yD.sub.j]$ is set equal to 2. Otherwise, if the block edge is also a transform block edge and the sample $p.sub.0$ or $q.sub.0$ is in a coding block with $ciip_flag$ equal to 1, $bS[xD.sub.i][yD.sub.j]$ is set equal to 2. Otherwise, if the block edge is also a transform block edge and the sample $p.sub.0$ or $q.sub.0$ is in a transform block which contains one or more non-zero transform coefficient levels, $bS[xD.sub.i][yD.sub.j]$ is set equal to 1. Otherwise, if the prediction mode of the coding subblock containing the sample $p.sub.0$ is different from the prediction mode of the coding subblock containing the sample $q.sub.0$, $bS[xD.sub.i][yD.sub.j]$ is set equal to 1. Otherwise, if $cIdx$ is equal to 0 and one or more of the following conditions are true, $bS[xD.sub.i][yD.sub.j]$ is set equal to 1: The coding subblock containing the sample $p.sub.0$ and the coding subblock containing the sample $q.sub.0$ are both coded in IBC prediction mode, and the absolute difference between the horizontal or vertical component of the motion vectors used in the prediction of the two coding subblocks is greater than or equal to 4 in units of quarter.sup.: luma samples. For the prediction of the coding subblock containing the sample $p.sub.0$ different reference pictures or a different number of motion vectors are used than for the prediction of the coding subblock

containing the sample $q_{\text{sub}.0}$. One motion vector is used to predict the coding subblock containing the sample $p_{\text{sub}.0}$ and one motion vector is used to predict the coding subblock containing the sample $q_{\text{sub}.0}$, and the absolute difference between the horizontal or vertical component of the motion vectors used is greater than or equal to 4 in units of quarter luma samples.

Two motion vectors and two different reference pictures are used to predict the coding subblock containing the sample $p_{\text{sub}.0}$, two motion vectors for the same two reference pictures are used to predict the coding subblock containing the sample $q_{\text{sub}.0}$ and the absolute difference between the horizontal or vertical component of the two motion vectors in the prediction of the two coding subblocks for the same reference picture is greater than or equal to 4 in units of quarter luma samples. Two motion vectors for the same reference picture are used to predict the coding subblock containing the sample $p_{\text{sub}.0}$, two motion vectors for the same reference picture are used to predict the coding subblock containing the sample $q_{\text{sub}.0}$ and both of the following conditions are true: The absolute difference between the horizontal or vertical component of list 0 motion vectors used in the prediction of the two coding subblocks is greater than or equal to 4 in units of quarter luma samples, or the absolute difference between the horizontal or vertical component of the list 1 motion vectors used in the prediction of the two coding subblocks is greater than or equal to 4 in units of quarter luma samples. The absolute difference between the horizontal or vertical component of list 0 motion vector used in the prediction of the coding subblock containing the sample $p_{\text{sub}.0}$ and the list 1 motion vector used in the prediction of the coding subblock containing the sample $q_{\text{sub}.0}$ is greater than or equal to 4 in units of quarter luma samples, or the absolute difference between the horizontal or vertical component of the list 1 motion vector used in the prediction of the coding subblock containing the sample $p_{\text{sub}.0}$ and list 0 motion vector used in the prediction of the coding subblock containing the sample $q_{\text{sub}.0}$ is greater than or equal to 4 in units of quarter luma samples. Otherwise, the variable $bS[xD_{\text{sub}.i}][yD_{\text{sub}.j}]$ is set equal to 0.

[0104] Herein, p may indicate a sample of block P that is adjacent to the deblocking filtering target boundary, and q may indicate a sample of block Q that is adjacent to the deblocking filtering target boundary.

[0105] Additionally, for example, the p_0 may indicate a sample of a block that is adjacent to a left side or top side of the deblocking filtering target boundary, and the q_0 may indicate a sample of a block that is adjacent to a right side or bottom side of the deblocking filtering target boundary. For example, in case a direction of the target boundary is vertical (i.e., in case the target boundary is a vertical boundary), the p_0 may indicate a sample of a block that is adjacent to the left side of the deblocking filtering target boundary, and the q_0 may indicate a sample of a block that is adjacent to the right side of the deblocking filtering target boundary. Alternatively, for example, in case a direction of the target boundary is horizontal (i.e., in case the target boundary is a horizontal boundary), the p_0 may indicate a sample of a block that is adjacent to the top side of the deblocking filtering target boundary, and the q_0 may indicate a sample of a block that is adjacent to the bottom side of the deblocking filtering target boundary.

[0106] Referring back to FIG. 5, the encoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may perform blocking filtering based on the bS (S530). For example, when the bS value is equal to 0, deblocking filtering is not applied to the target boundary. Meanwhile, based on the determined bS value, the filter that is applied to the boundary between blocks may be determined. The filter may be categorized as a strong filter and a weak filter. By performing filtering using different filters for each of a boundary of a position with a high likelihood of having block distortion occur therein and a boundary of a position with a low likelihood of having block distortion occur therein within the reconstructed picture, the encoding apparatus/decoding apparatus may increase coding efficiency.

[0107] FIG. 6 is a flowchart schematically illustrating an example of an ALF procedure. The ALF procedure (or process) disclosed in FIG. 6 may be performed in an encoding apparatus and a decoding apparatus. In this document, the coding apparatus may include the encoding apparatus

and/or the decoding apparatus.

[0108] Referring to FIG. 6, the coding apparatus derives a filter for ALF (**S610**). The filter may include filter coefficients. The coding apparatus may determine whether to apply the ALF, and when determining to apply the ALF, may derive a filter including filter coefficients for the ALF. Information for deriving a filter (coefficients) for ALF or a filter (coefficients) for ALF may be referred to as an ALF parameter. Information on whether ALF is applied (i.e., ALF enabled flag) and ALF data for deriving the filter may be signaled from the encoding apparatus to the decoding apparatus. ALF data may include information for deriving a filter for the ALF. Also, for example, for hierarchical control of ALF, an ALF enabled flag may be signaled at the SPS, picture header, slice header, and/or CTB level, respectively.

[0109] In order to derive the filter for the ALF, the activity and/or directivity of the current block (or ALF target block) is derived, and the filter may be derived based on the activity and/or the directionality. For example, the ALF process may be applied in units of 4×4 blocks (based on luma components). The current block or the ALF target block may be, for example, a CU, or may be a 4×4 block within a CU. Specifically, for example, filters for ALF may be derived based on first filters derived from information included in the ALF data and predefined second filters, and the coding apparatus may select one of the filters based on the activity and/or the directionality. The coding apparatus may use filter coefficients included in the selected filter for the ALF.

[0110] The coding apparatus performs filtering based on the filter (**S620**). Modified reconstructed samples may be derived based on the filtering. For example, the filter coefficients in the filter may be arranged or allocated according to a filter shape, and the filtering may be performed on reconstructed samples in the current block. Here, the reconstructed samples in the current block may be reconstructed samples after the deblocking filter process and the SAO process are completed. For example, one filter shape may be used, or one filter shape may be selected and used from among a plurality of predetermined filter shapes. For example, a filter shape applied to the luma component and a filter shape applied to the chroma component may be different. For example, a 7×7 diamond filter shape may be used for the luma component, and a 5×5 diamond filter shape may be used for the chroma component.

[0111] FIG. 7 illustrates an example of a filter shape for ALF. $C_0 \sim C_{11}$ of (a) and $C_0 \sim C_5$ of (b) may be filter coefficients that are depend on positions within each filter shape.

[0112] The (a) of FIG. 7 shows the shape of a 7×7 diamond filter, and the (b) of FIG. 8 shows the shape of a 5×5 diamond filter. In FIG. 8, C_n in the filter shape represents a filter coefficient. When n in C_n is the same, this indicates that the same filter coefficients can be assigned. In the present document, a position and/or unit to which filter coefficients are assigned according to the filter shape of the ALF may be referred to as a filter tap. In this case, one filter coefficient may be assigned to each filter tap, and the arrangement of the filter taps may correspond to a filter shape. A filter tap located at the center of the filter shape may be referred to as a center filter tap. The same filter coefficients may be assigned to two filter taps of the same n value that exist at positions corresponding to each other with respect to the center filter tap. For example, in the case of a 7×7 diamond filter shape, 25 filter taps are included, and since filter coefficients C_0 to C_{11} are assigned in a centrally symmetric form, filter coefficients may be assigned to the 25 filter taps using only 13 filter coefficients. Also, for example, in the case of a 5×5 diamond filter shape, 13 filter taps are included, and since filter coefficients C_0 to C_5 are assigned in a centrally symmetrical form, filter coefficients may be assigned to the 13 filter taps using only 7 filter coefficients. For example, in order to reduce the data amount of signaled information on filter coefficients, 12 filter coefficients among 13 filter coefficients for the 7×7 diamond filter shape may be signaled (explicitly), and one filter coefficient may be derived (implicitly). Also, for example, 6 filter coefficients among 7 filter coefficients for a 5×5 diamond filter shape may be signaled (explicitly) and one filter coefficient may be derived (implicitly).

[0113] According to an embodiment of the present document, the ALF parameter used for the ALF

process may be signaled through an adaptation parameter set (APS). The ALF parameter may be derived from filter information for the ALF or ALF data.

[0114] The ALF is a type of in-loop filtering technique that can be applied in video/image coding as described above. The ALF may be performed using a Wiener-based adaptive filter. This may be to minimize a mean square error (MSE) between original samples and decoded samples (or reconstructed samples). A high level design for an ALF tool may incorporate syntax elements accessible from the SPS and/or slice header (or tile group header).

[0115] Meanwhile, a picture header includes syntax elements being applied to the picture header, and the syntax elements may be applied to all slices of a picture that is related to the picture header. When a specific syntax element is applied only to a specific slice, the specific syntax element should be signaled from a slice header and not the picture header.

[0116] In the prior art, signaling of a control flag and parameters for enabling or disabling multiple tools for picture encoding or decoding existed in the picture header and were overridden in the slice header. This method provides flexibility that allows tool control to be performed at both the picture level and the slice level. However, when using this method, since the slice header is required to be verified after verifying the picture header, this method may burden the decoder.

[0117] Accordingly, the embodiment of the present disclosure proposes indication information indicating whether or not at least one tool is being applied at a picture level or a slice level. At this point, the indication information may be included in any one of a Sequence Parameter Set (SPS) and a Picture Parameter Set (PPS). That is, when a specific tool is activated (or enabled) within a CLVS, an indication or flag for indicating whether or not the specific tool is being applied at a picture level or a slice level may be signaled from a parameter set, such as SPS or PPS. Although the indication or flag may correspond to one tool, the present disclosure will not be limited only to this. For example, an indication or flag for indicating whether or not all tools, and not only a specific tool, are being applied at a picture level or a slice level may be signaled from a parameter set, such as SPS or PPS.

[0118] Although the control flag and parameters for enabling or disabling tools may be signaled at a picture level or slice level, the signaling is not performed at both the picture level and the slice level. For example, in case of obtaining indication information indicating whether or not a specific tool is being applied at a picture level, the control flag and parameters for enabling or disabling the specific tool may be signaled only at the picture level. Similarly, in case of obtaining indication information indicating whether or not a specific tool is being applied at a slice level, the control flag and parameters for enabling or disabling the specific tool may be signaled only at the slice level.

[0119] Additionally, for example, a tool that is designated to be applied at a picture level from a specific parameter set may be designated to be applied at a slice level from another parameter set of the same type.

[0120] For example, a PPS syntax including indication information may be as shown below in the following table.

TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 Descriptor pic_parameter_set_rbsp() { ...
rpl_present_in_ph_flag u(1) sao_present_in_ph_flag u(1) alf_present_in_ph_flag u(1)
deblocking_filter_control_present_flag u(1) if(deblocking_filter_control_present_flag) {
deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag u(1) deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag
u(1) pps_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag u(1) if(!pps_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag)
{ pps_beta_offset_div2 se(v) pps_tc_offset_div2 se(v) } }
constant_slice_header_params_enabled_flag u(1) ... }

[0121] Semantics of syntax elements included in the syntax of Table 2 may for example, be indicated as shown below in Table 3.

TABLE-US-00003 TABLE 3 rpl_present_in_ph_flag equal to 1 specifies the reference picture list signalling may be present in the PHs referring to the PPS. rpl_present_in_ph_flag equal to 0

specifies the reference picture list signalling may be present in the slice headers referring to the PPS. `sao_present_in_ph_flag` equal to 1 specifies the syntax elements for enabling SAO use may be present in the PHs referring to the PPS. `sao_present_in_ph_flag` equal to 0 specifies the syntax elements for enabling SAO use may be present in the slice headers referring to the PPS.

`alf_present_in_ph_flag` equal to 1 specifies the syntax elements for enabling ALF use may be present in the PHs referring to the PPS. `alf_present_in_ph_flag` equal to 0 specifies the syntax elements for enabling ALF use may be present in the slice headers referring to the PPS.

`deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag` equal to 1 specifies the presence of `pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag` in the PHs referring to the PPS.

`deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag` equal to 0 specifies the absence of `pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag` in PHs referring to the PPS. When not present, the value of `deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag` is inferred to be equal to 0.

`deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag` equal to 1 specifies the presence of `slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag` in the slice headers referring to the PPS.

`deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag` equal to 0 specifies the absence of `slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag` in slice headers referring to the PPS. When not present, the value of `deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag` is inferred to be equal to 0. It is a requirement of bitstream conformance that, the value of `deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag` and `deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag` shall not both be equal to 1.

[0122] Referring to the tables that are presented above, indication information may include a P flag indicating whether or not signaling of a reference picture list is applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, the indication information may designate whether information related to the signaling of a reference picture list is present (or exists) in the picture header or is present (or exists) in the slice header. For example, the flag may be indicated as `rpl_present_in_ph_flag`. Based on a case where a value of the corresponding flag is equal to 1, the information related to the signaling of a reference picture list is present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the corresponding flag is equal to 0, the information related to the signaling of a reference picture list is present in the slice header.

[0123] Additionally, the indication information may include a flag indicating whether or not a Sample Adaptive Offset (SAO) procedure is being applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, the indication information may designate whether information related to the SAO procedure is present (or exists) in the picture header or is present (or exists) in the slice header. For example, the flag may be indicated as `sao_present_in_ph_flag`. Based on a case where a value of the corresponding flag is equal to 1, the information related to the SAO procedure is present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the corresponding flag is equal to 0, the information related to the SAO procedure is present in the slice header.

[0124] Additionally, the indication information may include a flag indicating whether or not an Adaptive Loop Filter (ALF) procedure is being applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, the indication information may designate whether information related to the ALF procedure is present (or exists) in the picture header or is present (or exists) in the slice header. For example, the flag may be indicated as `alf_present_in_ph_flag`. Based on a case where a value of the corresponding flag is equal to 1, the information related to the ALF procedure is present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the corresponding flag is equal to 0, the information related to the ALF procedure is present in the slice header.

[0125] Additionally, the indication information may include at least one flag indicating whether or not a deblocking procedure is being applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, based on the at least one flag, information related to the deblocking procedure may be present (or may exist) in any one of the picture header and a slice header. For example, the at least one flag may be indicated as `deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag` or `deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag`. For example, based on a case where a value of the at

least one flag is equal to 1, a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the picture header may be present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 0, a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the picture header may not be present in the picture header.

[0126] Alternatively, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 1, a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the slice header may be present in the slice header. And, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 0, a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the slice header may not be present in the slice header. At this point, values of deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag and deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag may not be both equal to 1.

[0127] Meanwhile, a picture header syntax may be as shown below in the following table.

TABLE-US-00004 TABLE 4 Descriptor picture_header_rbsp() { ... if(rpl_present_in_ph_flag) { for(i = 0; i < 2; i++) { if(num_ref_pic_lists_in_sps[i] > 0 && !pps_ref_pic_list_sps_idc[i] && (i == 0 || (i == 1 && rpl1_idx_present_flag))) pic_rpl_sps_flag[i] u(1) if(pic_rpl_sps_flag[i]) { if(num_ref_pic_lists_in_sps[i] > 1 && (i == 0 || (i == 1 && rpl1_idx_present_flag))) pic_rpl_idx[i] u(v) } else ref_pic_list_struct(i, num_ref_pic_lists_in_sps[i]) for(j = 0; j < NumLtrpEntries[i][RplsIdx[i]]; j++) { if(ltrp_in_slice_header_flag[i][RplsIdx[i]]) pic_poc_lsb_lt[i][j] u(v) pic_delta_poc_msb_present_flag[i][j] u(1) if(pic_delta_poc_msb_present_flag[i][j]) pic_delta_poc_msb_cycle_lt[i][j] ue(v) } } } ... if(sps_sao_enabled_flag && sao_present_in_ph_flag) { pic_sao_luma_enabled_flag u(1) if(ChromaArrayType != 0) pic_sao_chroma_enabled_flag u(1) } if(sps_alf_enabled_flag && alf_present_in_ph_flag) { pic_alf_enabled_flag u(1) if(pic_alf_enabled_flag) { pic_num_alf_aps_ids_luma u(3) for(i = 0; i < pic_num_alf_aps_ids_luma; i++) pic_alf_aps_id_luma[i] u(3) if(ChromaArrayType != 0) pic_alf_chroma_idc u(2) if(pic_alf_chroma_idc) pic_alf_aps_id_chroma u(3) } } ... if(deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag) { pic_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag u(1) if(pic_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag) { pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag u(1) if(pic_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag) { pic_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag u(1) if(!pic_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag) { pic_beta_offset_div2 se(v) pic_tc_offset_div2 se(v) } } } } ... } }

[0128] Semantics of syntax elements included in the syntax of Table 4 may, for example, be indicated as shown below in Table 5.

TABLE-US-00005 TABLE 5 pic_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag equal to 1 specifies that pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag is present in the PH.

pic_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag equal to 0 specifies that

pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag is not present in the PH. When

pic_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag is not present, it is inferred to be equal to 0.

pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag equal to 1 specifies that deblocking parameters are present to the PH. pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag equal to 0 specifies that deblocking parameters are not present in the PH. When not present, the value of pic_pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag is inferred to be equal to 0. pic_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag equal to 1 specifies that the operation of the deblocking filter is not applied for the slices associated with the PH.

pic_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag equal to 0 specifies that the operation of the deblocking filter is applied for the slices associated with the PH. When pic_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag is not

present, it is inferred to be equal to pps_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag. pic_beta_offset_div2 and pic_tc_offset_div2 specify the deblocking parameter offsets for β and tC (divided by 2) for the slices associated with the PH. The values of pic_beta_offset_div2 and pic_tc_offset_div2 shall both be in the range of -6 to 6, inclusive. When not present, the values of pic_beta_offset_div2 and pic_to_offset_div2 are inferred to be equal to pps_beta_offset_div and pps_tc_offset_div2, respectively.

[0129] Referring to the tables that are presented above, when a value of deblocking_filter_ph_override_enabled_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not the deblocking procedure is being applied at the picture level, is equal to 1, pic_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag may be signaled. When a value of pic_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag is equal to 1, the pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the picture header, may be present in the picture header. Alternatively, when a value of pic_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag is equal to 0, pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the picture header, may not be present in the picture header.

[0130] Additionally, when a value of the pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the picture header, is equal to 1, the deblocking parameters may be present (or may exist) in the picture header. And, when a value of the pic_deblocking_filter_override_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the picture header, is equal to 0, the deblocking parameters may not be present (or may not exist) in the picture header.

[0131] Additionally, when a value of pic_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag is equal to 1, a deblocking filter may not be applied for slices being related to the picture header. And, when a value of pic_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag is equal to 0, a deblocking filter may be applied for slices being related to the picture header.

[0132] Additionally, pic_beta_offset_div2 and pic_tc_offset_div2 may respectively designate deblocking parameter offset for β and tC (value divided by 2) for slices related to the picture header. Values of pic_beta_offset_div2 and pic_tc_offset_div2 may all be within a range of -6 to 6.

[0133] Meanwhile, a slice header syntax may be as shown below in the following table.

TABLE-US-00006 TABLE 6 Descriptor slice_header() { ... if(!rpl_present_in_ph_flag && ((nal_unit_type != IDR_W_RADL && nal_unit_type != IDR_N_LP) || !sps_idr_rpl_present_flag)) { for(i = 0; i < 2; i++) { if(num_ref_pic_lists_in_sps[i] > 0 && !pps_ref_pic_list_sps_idc[i] && (i == 0 || (i == 1 && rpl1_idx_present_flag))) slice_rpl_sps_flag[i] u(1) if slice_rpl_sps_flag[i]) { if num_ref_pic_lists_in_sps[i] > 1 && (i == 0 || (1 == 1 && rpl1_idx_present_flag))) slice_rpl_idx[i] u(v) } else ref_pic_list_struct(i_num_ref_pic_lists_in_sps[i]) for(j = 0; j < NumLtrpEntrie[i][RplsIdx[i]]; j++) { if(ltrp_in_slice_header_flag[i][RplsIdx[i]]) slice_poc_lsb_lt[i][j] u(v) slice_delta_poc_msb_present_flag[i][j] if(slice_delta_poc_msb_present_flag[i][j]) slice_delta_poc_msb_cycle_lt[i][j] ue(v) } } } if(rpl_present_in_ph_flag || ((nal_unit_type != IDR_W_RADL && nal_unit_type != IDR_N_LP) || !sps_idr_rpl_present_flag)) { if((slice_type != I && num_ref_entries[0][RplsIdx[0]] > 1) || (slice_type == B && num_ref_entries[1][RplsIdx[1]] > 1)) { num_ref_idx_active_override_flag u(1) if(num_ref_idx_active_override_flag) for 1 = 0; 1 < (slice_type == B ? 2 : 1); 1++) if(num_ref_entries[i][RplsIdx[i]] > 1) num_ref_idx_active_minus1[i] ue(v) } } ... if(

```

sps_sao_enabled_flag && !sao_present_in_ph_flag ) {      slice_sao_luma_flag u(1)      if(
ChromaArrayType != 0 )      slice_sao_chroma_flag u(1)      }      if( sps_alf_enabled_flag
&& !alf_present_in_ph_flag ) {      slice_alf_enabled_flag u(1)      if( slice_alf_enabled_flag )
{      slice_num_alf_aps_ids_luma u(3)      for( i = 0; 1 < slice_num_alf_aps_ids_luma; i++
)      slice_alf_aps_id_luma[ i ] u(3)      if( ChromaArrayType != 0 )
slice_alf_chroma_idc u(2)      if( slice_alf_chroma_idc )      slice_alf_aps_id_chroma
u(3)      }      }      if( deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag )
slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag u(1)      if( slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag ) {
slice_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag u(1)      if( !slice_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag ) {
slice_beta_offset_div2 se(v)      slice_tc_offset_div2 se(v)      }      } ... }

```

[0134] Semantics of syntax elements included in the syntax of Table 6 may, for example, be indicated as shown below in Table 7.

TABLE-US-00007 TABLE 7 slice_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag equal to 1 specifies that slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag is present in the slice.

slice_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag equal to 0 specifies that slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag is not present in the slice. When

slice_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag is not present, it is inferred to be equal to 0.

slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag equal to 1 specifies that deblocking parameters are present in the slice. slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag equal to 0 specifies that deblocking parameters are not present in the slice. When not present, the value of slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag is inferred to be equal to 0. slice_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag equal to 1 specifies that the operation of the deblocking filter is not applied for the slice. slice_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag equal to 0 specifies that the operation of the deblocking filter is applied for the slice. When slice_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag is not present, it is inferred to be equal to

pps_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag. slice_beta_offset_div2_and_slice_tc_offset_div2 specify the deblocking parameter offsets for β and tC (divided by 2) for the slice. The values of slice_beta_offset_div2 and pic_tc_offset_div2 shall both be in the range of -6 to 6 , inclusive.

When not present, the values of slice_beta_offset_div2 and pic_to_offset_div2 are inferred to be equal to pps_beta_offset_div2 and pps_tc_offset_div2, respectively.

[0135] Referring to the tables that are presented above, when a value of deblocking_filter_sh_override_enabled_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not the deblocking procedure is being applied at the slice level, is equal to 1, slice_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag may be signaled. When a value of slice_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag is equal to 1, the slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the slice header, may be present in the slice header. Alternatively, when a value of slice_deblocking_filter_override_present_flag is equal to 0, slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the slice header, may not be present in the slice header.

[0136] Additionally, when a value of the slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the slice header, is equal to 1, the deblocking parameters may be present (or may exist) in the slice header. And, when a value of the slice_deblocking_filter_override_flag, which corresponds to a flag indicating whether or not a parameter related to the deblocking procedure is present in the slice header, is equal to 0, the deblocking parameters may not be present (or may not exist) in the slice header.

[0137] Additionally, when a value of slice_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag is equal to 1, a deblocking filter may not be applied for slices being related to the slice header. And, when a value of slice_deblocking_filter_disabled_flag is equal to 0, a deblocking filter may be applied for slices

being related to the slice header.

[0138] Additionally, slice_beta_offset_div2 and slice_tc_offset_div2 may respectively designate deblocking parameter offset for β and tC (value divided by 2) for slices. Values of slice_beta_offset_div2 and slice_tc_offset_div2 may all be within a range of -6 to 6.

[0139] FIG. 8 is a flowchart illustrating an operation of an image encoding apparatus according to an embodiment, and FIG. 9 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an image encoding apparatus according to an embodiment.

[0140] The method disclosed in FIG. 8 may be performed by the encoding apparatus disclosed in FIG. 2 or FIG. 9. S810 and S820 of FIG. 8 may be performed by the image predictor 220, the residual processor 230 or the filter 260 shown in FIGS. 2, and S830 of FIG. 8 may be performed by the entropy encoder 240 shown in FIG. 2. Furthermore, operations according to S810 to S830 are based on part of the description presented above in FIG. 1 to FIG. 7. Therefore, detailed description that overlap with the description of FIG. 1 to FIG. 7 will be omitted or briefly presented for simplicity.

[0141] Referring to FIG. 8, an encoding apparatus according to an embodiment may generate indication information indicating whether at least one tool that is to be applied to a current block is applied at a picture level or a slice level (S810).

[0142] For example, the image predictor 220 of the encoding apparatus may generate indication information including a flag indicating whether signaling of a reference picture list is applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 1, information related to the signaling of a reference picture list may be present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 0, information related to the signaling of a reference picture list may be present in the slice header.

[0143] For example, the filter 260 of the encoding apparatus may generate indication information including a flag indicating whether a Sample Adaptive Offset (SAO) procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 1, information related to the SAO procedure may be present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 0, information related to the SAO procedure may be present in the slice header.

[0144] For example, the filter 260 of the encoding apparatus may generate indication information including a flag indicating whether an Adaptive Loop Filter (ALF) procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 1, information related to the ALF procedure may be present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 0, the information related to the ALF procedure may be present in the slice header.

[0145] Alternatively, for example, the filter 260 of the encoding apparatus may generate indication information including at least one flag indicating whether a deblocking procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level. Based on the at least one flag, information related to the deblocking procedure may be present in one of a picture header and a slice header. For example, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 1, a flag indicating whether parameters related to the deblocking procedure are present in the picture header may be present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 0, a flag indicating whether parameters related to the deblocking procedure are present in the picture header may not be present in the picture header.

[0146] The encoding apparatus according to the embodiment may generate information related to the at least one tool (S820). For example, the image predictor 220 of the encoding apparatus may generate information related to the signaling of the reference picture list. Alternatively, for example, the filter 260 of the encoding apparatus may generate at least one of the information related to the SAO procedure, the information related to the ALF procedure, and the information related to the deblocking procedure.

[0147] The encoding apparatus according to the embodiment may encode the indication information and image information including the information related to the at least one tool (**S830**). Additionally, the image information may include prediction information for the current block. The prediction information may include information on an inter prediction mode or an intra prediction mode that is being performed on the current block. Additionally, the image information may include residual information that is generated from original samples by the residual processor **230** of the encoding apparatus.

[0148] Meanwhile, the bitstream having image information encoded therein may be transmitted to the decoding apparatus through a network or a (digital) storage medium. Herein, the network may include a broadcast network and/or a communication network, and so on, and the digital storage medium may include various storage media, such as USB, SD, CD, DVD, Blu-ray, HDD, SSD, and so on.

[0149] FIG. **10** is a flowchart illustrating an operation of an image decoding apparatus according to an embodiment, and FIG. **11** is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of an image decoding apparatus according to an embodiment.

[0150] The method disclosed in FIG. **10** may be performed by the decoding apparatus disclosed in FIG. **3** or FIG. **11**. More specifically, **S1010** to **S1030** may be performed by the entropy decoder **310** shown in FIG. **3**. Additionally, **S1040** may be performed by the predictor **330**, the residual processor **320**, the filter **350** or the adder **340** shown in FIG. **3**. Furthermore, operations according to **S1010** to **S1040** are based on part of the description presented above in FIG. **1** to FIG. **7**. Therefore, detailed description that overlap with the description of FIG. **1** to FIG. **7** will be omitted or briefly presented for simplicity.

[0151] A decoding apparatus according to the embodiment may obtain indication information indicating whether at least one tool for a current block is applied at a picture level or a slice level (**S1010**). For example, the indication information may include a flag indicating whether signaling of a reference picture list for a current block is applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, the indication information may include a flag indicating whether a Sample Adaptive Offset (SAO) procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level. For example, the indication information may include a flag indicating whether an Adaptive Loop Filter (ALF) procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level. Alternatively, for example, the indication information may include at least one flag indicating whether a deblocking procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level.

[0152] The decoding apparatus according to the embodiment may determine whether information related to the at least one tool is present in a picture header or in a slice header based on the indication information (**S1020**).

[0153] For example, based on a case where a value of a flag indicating whether the signaling of a reference picture list is applied at a picture level or a slice level is equal to 1, it may be determined that information related to the signaling of the reference picture list is present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 0, it may be determined that information related to the signaling of the reference picture list is present in the slice header.

[0154] For example, based on a case where a value of a flag indicating whether the SAO procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level is equal to 1, it may be determined that information related to the SAO procedure is present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 0, it may be determined that information related to the SAO procedure is present in the slice header.

[0155] For example, based on a case where a value of a flag indicating whether the ALF procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level is equal to 1, it may be determined that information related to the ALF procedure is present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the flag is equal to 0, it may be determined that information related to the ALF procedure is present in the slice header.

[0156] Alternatively, for example, based on at least one flag indicating whether the deblocking procedure is applied at a picture level or a slice level, information related to the deblocking procedure may be present in one of the picture header and the slice header. For example, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 1, it may be determined that a flag indicating whether parameters related to the deblocking procedure are present in the picture header is present in the picture header. And, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 0, it may be determined that a flag indicating whether parameters related to the deblocking procedure are present in the picture header is not present in the picture header. Alternatively, for example, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 1, it may be determined that a flag indicating whether parameters related to the deblocking procedure are present in the slice header is present in the slice header. And, based on a case where a value of the at least one flag is equal to 0, it may be determined that a flag indicating whether parameters related to the deblocking procedure are present in the slice header is not present in the slice header.

[0157] The decoding apparatus according to the embodiment may parse the information related to the at least one tool from the picture header or the slice header based on the determination (**S1030**).

[0158] The decoding apparatus according to the embodiment may decode the current block based on the information related to the at least one tool (**S1040**). For example, based on information related to signaling of a reference picture list, which receives and parses one of the picture header and the slice header, the predictor **330** of the decoding apparatus may perform prediction on the current block. For example, based on information related to an SAO procedure, which receives and parses one of the picture header and the slice header, the filter **350** of the decoding apparatus may perform an SAO procedure for reconstructed samples. For example, based on information related to an ALF procedure, which receives and parses one of the picture header and the slice header, the filter **350** of the decoding apparatus may perform an ALF procedure for reconstructed samples. Alternatively, for example, based on information related to a deblocking procedure, which receives and parses one of the picture header and the slice header, the filter **350** of the decoding apparatus may perform a deblocking procedure for reconstructed samples.

[0159] In the above-described embodiment, the methods are described based on the flowchart having a series of steps or blocks. The present disclosure is not limited to the order of the above steps or blocks. Some steps or blocks may occur simultaneously or in a different order from other steps or blocks as described above. Further, those skilled in the art will understand that the steps shown in the above flowchart are not exclusive, that further steps may be included, or that one or more steps in the flowchart may be deleted without affecting the scope of the present disclosure.

[0160] The method according to the above-described embodiments of the present document may be implemented in software form, and the encoding apparatus and/or decoding apparatus according to the present document is, for example, may be included in the apparatus that performs the image processing of a TV, a computer, a smart phone, a set-top box, a display device, and so on.

[0161] When the embodiments in the present document are implemented in software, the above-described method may be implemented as a module (process, function, and so on) that performs the above-described function. A module may be stored in a memory and executed by a processor. The memory may be internal or external to the processor, and may be coupled to the processor by various well-known means. The processor may include an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), other chipsets, logic circuits, and/or data processing devices. Memory may include read-only memory (ROM), random access memory (RAM), flash memory, memory cards, storage media, and/or other storage devices. That is, the embodiments described in the present document may be implemented and performed on a processor, a microprocessor, a controller, or a chip. For example, the functional parts shown in each figure may be implemented and performed on a computer, a processor, a microprocessor, a controller, or a chip. In this case, information on instructions or an algorithm for implementation may be stored in a digital storage medium.

[0162] In addition, the decoding apparatus and the encoding apparatus to which the present

disclosure is applied may be included in a multimedia broadcasting transmission/reception apparatus, a mobile communication terminal, a home cinema video apparatus, a digital cinema video apparatus, a surveillance camera, a video chatting apparatus, a real-time communication apparatus such as video communication, a mobile streaming apparatus, a storage medium, a camcorder, a VoD service providing apparatus, an Over the top (OTT) video apparatus, an Internet streaming service providing apparatus, a three-dimensional (3D) video apparatus, a teleconference video apparatus, a transportation user equipment (i.e., vehicle user equipment, an airplane user equipment, a ship user equipment, and so on) and a medical video apparatus and may be used to process video signals and data signals. For example, the Over the top (OTT) video apparatus may include a game console, a blue-ray player, an internet access TV, a home theater system, a smart phone, a tablet PC, a Digital Video Recorder (DVR), and the like.

[0163] Furthermore, the processing method to which the present document is applied may be produced in the form of a program that is to be executed by a computer and may be stored in a computer-readable recording medium. Multimedia data having a data structure according to the present disclosure may also be stored in computer-readable recording media. The computer-readable recording media include all types of storage devices in which data readable by a computer system is stored. The computer-readable recording media may include a BD, a Universal Serial Bus (USB), ROM, PROM, EPROM, EEPROM, RAM, CD-ROM, a magnetic tape, a floppy disk, and an optical data storage device, for example. Furthermore, the computer-readable recording media includes media implemented in the form of carrier waves (i.e., transmission through the Internet). In addition, a bitstream generated by the encoding method may be stored in a computer-readable recording medium or may be transmitted over wired/wireless communication networks.

[0164] In addition, the embodiments of the present document may be implemented with a computer program product according to program codes, and the program codes may be performed in a computer by the embodiments of the present document. The program codes may be stored on a carrier which is readable by a computer.

[0165] FIG. 12 shows an example of a content streaming system to which embodiments disclosed in the present specification may be applied.

[0166] Referring to FIG. 12, the content streaming system to which the embodiment(s) of the present document is applied may largely include an encoding server, a streaming server, a web server, a media storage, a user device, and a multimedia input device.

[0167] The encoding server compresses content input from multimedia input devices such as a smartphone, a camera, a camcorder, and so on. Into digital data to generate a bitstream and transmit the bitstream to the streaming server. As another example, when the multimedia input devices such as smartphones, cameras, camcorders, and so on, directly generate a bitstream, the encoding server may be omitted.

[0168] The bitstream may be generated by an encoding method or a bitstream generating method to which the embodiment(s) of the present disclosure is applied, and the streaming server may temporarily store the bitstream in the process of transmitting or receiving the bitstream.

[0169] The streaming server transmits the multimedia data to the user device based on a user's request through the web server, and the web server serves as a medium for informing the user of a service. When the user requests a desired service from the web server, the web server delivers it to a streaming server, and the streaming server transmits multimedia data to the user. In this case, the content streaming system may include a separate control server. In this case, the control server serves to control a command/response between devices in the content streaming system.

[0170] The streaming server may receive content from a media storage and/or an encoding server. For example, when the content is received from the encoding server, the content may be received in real time. In this case, in order to provide a smooth streaming service, the streaming server may store the bitstream for a predetermined time.

[0171] Examples of the user device may include a mobile phone, a smartphone, a laptop computer,

a digital broadcasting terminal, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a portable multimedia player (PMP), navigation, a slate PC, tablet PCs, ultrabooks, wearable devices (e.g., Smartwatches, smart glasses, head mounted displays), digital TVs, desktops computer, digital signage, and the like. Each server in the content streaming system may be operated as a distributed server, in which case data received from each server may be distributed.

[0172] Each server in the content streaming system may be operated as a distributed server, and in this case, data received from each server may be distributed and processed.

[0173] The claims described herein may be combined in various ways. For example, the technical features of the method claims of the present document may be combined and implemented as an apparatus, and the technical features of the apparatus claims of the present document may be combined and implemented as a method. In addition, the technical features of the method claim of the present document and the technical features of the apparatus claim may be combined to be implemented as an apparatus, and the technical features of the method claim of the present document and the technical features of the apparatus claim may be combined and implemented as a method.

Claims

1. A decoding apparatus for an image decoding, the decoding apparatus comprising: a memory; and at least one processor connected to the memory, the at least one processor configured to: obtain indication information related to whether deblocking filter information is present in a picture header or a slice header; determine in which header among the picture header or the slice header the deblocking filter information is present based on the indication information; parse the deblocking filter information from the picture header or the slice header based on the determination; and decode a current block based on the deblocking filter information, wherein the indication information is included in a Picture Parameter Set (PPS), wherein the picture header includes information applies commonly to all slices in a picture, wherein the PPS includes information applies commonly to one or more pictures, and wherein a syntax level in which the indication information is included and a syntax level in which the deblocking filter information is included is different.

2. An encoding apparatus for image encoding, the encoding apparatus comprising: a memory; and at least one processor connected to the memory, the at least one processor configured to: generate deblocking filter information; determine in which header among a picture header or a slice header the deblocking filter information is present; generate indication information related to whether the deblocking filter information is present in the picture header or the slice header; and encode image information including the indication information and the deblocking filter information, wherein the indication information is configured to represent in which header among the picture header or the slice header the deblocking filter information is present, wherein the indication information is included in a Picture Parameter Set (PPS), wherein the picture header includes information applies commonly to all slices in a picture, wherein the PPS includes information applies commonly to one or more pictures, and wherein a syntax level in which the indication information is included and a syntax level in which the deblocking filter information is included is different.

3. A transmission method of data for an image, the transmission method comprising: at least one processor configured to obtain a bitstream for the image, wherein the bitstream is generated based on: generating deblocking filter information, determining in which header among a picture header or a slice header the deblocking filter information is present, generating indication information related to whether the deblocking filter information is present in the picture header or the slice header, and encoding image information including the indication information and the deblocking filter information; and a transmitter configured to transmit the data comprising the bitstream, wherein the indication information is configured to represent in which header among the picture

header or the slice header the deblocking filter information is present, wherein the indication information is included in a Picture Parameter Set (PPS), wherein the picture header includes information applies commonly to all slices in a picture, wherein the PPS includes information applies commonly to one or more pictures, and wherein a syntax level in which the indication information is included and a syntax level in which the deblocking filter information is included is different.
